

Giselle Terrazas Saldana

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EDUCATION:

Northern Virginia Community College
Associates Degree in Computer Science

Expected May, 2027
Alexandria, VA

Grace Hopper Center
Advanced Studies Diploma

Expected June, 2027
Arlington, VA

RELATED EXPERIENCE:

Object Oriented Programming

- Developed programs using C++ and object-oriented principles
- Designed a console-based To-Do List application using ncurses
- Applied classes, modular design, and structured problem-solving

Introduction to Discrete Structures

- Learning foundational discrete mathematics concepts
- Applying logical reasoning, sets, functions, and mathematical proofs
- Strengthening analytical and computational thinking skills

Web Scripting Languages

- Built a cosmetology appointment booking platform using Django
- Implemented backend scheduling logic and database interaction
- Applied client-server architecture principles

Introduction to Problem Solving and Programming

- Developed strong foundations in Python programming
- Applied algorithmic thinking to solve computational problems
- Gained understanding of structured programming and debugging

Introduction to Engineering Design

- Designed and built a functional hydroponics system
- Developed a Bluetooth-controlled vehicle integrating wiring and programming
- Utilized CAD software for modeling and design
- Applied interdisciplinary problem-solving with math and science concepts

TECHNICAL SKILLS, ADDITIONAL SKILLS, AND CERTIFICATIONS:

- Python, C++, Django, HTML, CSS, Object-Oriented Programming, and CAD
- Bilingual: English & Spanish
- C++ Certified Entry-Level Programmer - OpenEDG C++ Institute - February 2026
- American Legion Scholastic Award (JROTC) - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE:**EIP Alumni Impact Study Research Assistant**

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA (Remote)

January 2025 – August 2025

- Conducted one-hour qualitative interviews with EIP alumni via Zoom
- Coordinated interview scheduling through professional email communication
- Recorded and securely uploaded interview sessions in a timely manner
- Drafted and sent follow-up and thank-you correspondence to participants
- Organized digital research files to maintain accuracy and confidentiality
- Participated in periodic research meetings to discuss progress and insights

Independent Web Developer

Kristi Bickel – Author Website (Remote) | October 2025 – December 2025

- Designed and launched a professional author website using Wix
- Translated client vision into structured site layout, branding, and navigation
- Organized and formatted content to enhance readability and user experience
- Collaborated directly with client through virtual communication to refine design and functionality
- Delivered a fully published, responsive website supporting book promotion efforts

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES:

- EIP Program - EIP Program Scholar | July 2022 – Present
 - Participate in college readiness and research programs since 7th grade
 - Engage in advanced academic opportunities and skill-building activities
- VA-821 Space Force JROTC - Squadron Commander | August 2025 – Present
 - Lead and coordinate squadron activities and events
 - Support team development and mentor fellow cadets
- ACC Django Girls - Vice President | 2025 – Present
 - Assist in organizing workshops and events to teach coding and web development
 - Collaborate with executive team to develop programs for participants